Matthew Keen

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Transportation Economist

Data-loving transportation economist with a soft spot for rail. I dig into complex datasets to uncover stories that shape smarter policy, investment, and operations. Experienced in building models, metrics, and decision tools and in turning technical results into clear, actionable insights for partners across government and the private sector.

Employment History

Economist

USDOT - Volpe National Transportation Systems Center
Cambridge, MA January 2017 to September 2025

- Led and supported economic research, policy evaluations, and cost-benefit analyses for initiatives such as the BUILD grant program, federal partners including FMCSA and FRA, and non-federal partners such as SAIPRC, shaping investment and planning decisions across rail, highway, and multimodal networks nationwide.
- Analyzed large-scale datasets (including freight and passenger rail delay data, highway performance monitoring systems, and various other transportation system performance indicators) to assess the efficacy of billions of dollars in public transportation investments, improving efficiency, resilience, and equity.
- Collaborated with federal partners at DOT, state DOTs, and local agencies to develop actionable recommendations, contributing to measurable improvements in safety outcomes, congestion reduction, and equitable access for disadvantaged communities.
- Produced dozens of technical reports, dashboards, and decision-support tools that translated econometric and statistical analyses into clear policy guidance, enabling decision-makers to act on insights within tight federal and state planning timelines.
- Enhanced decision-making by integrating quantitative analysis with stakeholder priorities, influencing strategies for transportation infrastructure projects valued in the hundreds of millions of dollars annually.

Education

Master of Arts in Economics, San Francisco State University
Bachelor of Arts in Economics, Sonoma State University

Core Competencies

- Economic Forecasting
- Regulatory Impact Analysis & Policy Analysis
- Benefit-Cost Analysis
- Transportation Performance Metrics
- Stakeholder Engagement & Collaboration
- Applied Statistics & Econometrics
- Data Storytelling & Visualization for Decision-Making
- Travel Demand & Delay Modeling

Technical Skills

- Programming, Analysis & Data Management: R, Python, SQL
- Data Visualization: Power BI, Tableau
- Collaboration: GitHub
- Productivity: Microsoft Office Suite
- Statistical Methods: Regression, Forecasting, Simulation